

G Bass 1X

A monophonic analogue-style bass synth with three filters, accent and glide.



Overview

G Bass 1X is a one-note-at-a-time bass synthesizer. Its oscillator section has a saw or pulse wave with pulse-width control, a sub oscillator one or two octaves down, a detuned second oscillator, a unison spread for thick, detuned Reese-style sounds, and noise.

Three filters give three characters: LADDER is warm and round (the bass drops a little as the resonance rises), ACID is sharper and keeps its bass, for squelchy acid lines, and 12 dB is a clean, gentle state-variable filter. Hard-played notes trigger the ACCENT, which opens the filter and hits harder.

GLIDE slides between notes, either always or only when notes overlap. The last note you play always wins. A slow analogue drift moves the pitch, the second oscillator, the pulse width and the cutoff, and every new note gets a slightly different tuning.

Reach for it for

- Acid lines with accent and slides
- Fat, round analogue-style basses
- Detuned, growling Reese basses (UNISON)
- Clean sub basses (Sine Sub, SUB+)
- Plucks, zaps and wobbles

Playing it

1. Insert G Bass 1X on a track (it has no audio input; it makes its own sound).
2. Arm the track for recording with a MIDI input selected and monitoring on, or draw notes in a MIDI item on the track.
3. Play: it responds on every MIDI channel, plays one note at a time (the last note held wins) and follows pitch bend over +/-2 semitones. The MIDI light flashes on each note.
4. Pick a sound by clicking the display for the patch list, or with PATCH - and PATCH +.

Controls

Display and patches

Display	Shows the patch number and name; a * after the number means you have changed it. The second line shows the filter type and glide mode, or the value of the knob you are turning. Click it for the full patch list.
PATCH - / PATCH +	Step to the previous or next patch. A patch sets the oscillators, LFO, filter, envelopes and performance controls; DRIFT, DRIVE, VOLUME, SUB+ and the IN / OUT strip are left as they are.
MIDI	Flashes when a note arrives.

OSCILLATORS

SAW / PULSE	The main oscillator's wave. SAW is bright and buzzy; PULSE is hollower and can be shaped with PW.
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PW	Pulse width, 5 to 95% (50% is a square wave). Only with PULSE.
SUB -1 / SUB -2	The sub oscillator's level, 0 to 100%. Click the label to switch it between one and two octaves below the note.
OSC2 -1 / OSC2 0 / OSC2 +1	The level of a second saw oscillator, 0 to 100%. Click the label to set its octave: one down, the same, or one up.
DETUNE	Detunes the second oscillator, 0 to 50 cents. A few cents thickens; more gives a beating, chorused sound.
UNISON	Adds two more saws, detuned either side of the note (up to 30 cents), for a wide, thick, Reese-style sound.
NOISE	Adds white noise, for breath and grit.

LFO

RATE (SINE / TRI / SAW / SQUARE / S&H)	The LFO speed, 0.05 to 20 Hz. The label shows the shape: click it to step through sine, triangle, saw, square and sample-and-hold (random steps).
PITCH	How much the LFO moves the pitch, 0 to 100 cents. Small amounts give vibrato.
CUTOFF	How much the LFO sweeps the filter, up to three octaves - for wobbles.
PWM	How much the LFO moves the pulse width (PULSE wave only).

FILTER

LADDER / ACID / 12 dB	The filter type. LADDER: warm 24 dB per octave. ACID: sharp 24 dB per octave that keeps its bass at high resonance. 12 dB: a clean, gentler state-variable filter.
CUTOFF	The filter frequency, 20 Hz to 18 kHz.
RES	Resonance, 0 to 100%. High settings give the squelch; the

	ladder filters can self-oscillate near the top.
ENV	How far the filter envelope opens the filter, up to seven octaves.
KEY	Key tracking: how much the cutoff follows the notes you play, so higher notes stay as bright as lower ones (100% = the cutoff moves an octave for each octave played).

FILTER ENVELOPE

ATTACK	0.5 ms to 3 s.
DECAY	5 ms to 5 s.
SUSTAIN	0 to 100%.
RELEASE	5 ms to 5 s.

AMP ENVELOPE

ATTACK	0.5 ms to 3 s.
DECAY	5 ms to 5 s.
SUSTAIN	0 to 100%. Set it to 0 for plucked sounds that die away while you hold the key.
RELEASE	5 ms to 5 s.

When you play a new note while the previous one is still held, the envelopes carry on rather than restarting, as on the classic mono synths.

PERFORMANCE

GLIDE ALL / GLIDE LEG	The glide time, 0 to 1000 ms. Click the label to switch the mode: ALL glides into every note; LEG glides only between overlapping (legato) notes, so you choose the slides by how you play.
ACCENT	How much hard-played notes (above half velocity) open the filter further and hit harder.

VELOCITY

How much the playing strength changes the level, 0 to 100%.

MASTER

DRIFT

The analogue drift, 0 to 100% (25% by default). See Drift below.

DRIVE

Gentle saturation after the filter, 0 to 100% (15% by default).

VOLUME

The synth's level, -24 to +6 dB.

Drift

In G Bass 1X, drift moves the pitch (up to +/-20 cents at 100%), the second oscillator's tuning, the pulse width and the filter cutoff, slowly and randomly. Every new note also gets a small random tuning offset (up to +/-6 cents at 100%). 0% switches it all off.

IN / OUT

SAT

Band saturation on the way out: only the lows and highs are saturated (the mids stay clean), with a soft curve that loosens as the level rises.

**OFF / CLIP / LIMIT
(OUT)**

The final stage: nothing, a soft clipper at -0.3 dBFS (no latency, the default), or a lookahead limiter holding the peaks at -0.3 dBFS (3 ms latency, compensated by REAPER). The CLIP key flashes red while it is clipping.

SUB+

ON

Adds a pure sine an octave below the note, plus soft harmonics an octave above it. Both follow the amp envelope. Useful for weight on small speakers and for basses that need to be heard as well as felt.

SUB

The level of the sine an octave below (50% by default).

UPPER

The level of the harmonics an octave above (30% by default).

Size and help

S / M / L

Panel size: small, medium or large.

?

Opens a pop-up with the design credit, the GFX website address and the address of this manual. Click anywhere to close it.

Presets

Mono Acid

Saw into the ACID filter at 300 Hz with high resonance, a short filter decay, strong accent and legato glide - the squelchy acid line.

Mono Sub

A 40% pulse with a strong sub oscillator through a gently resonant ACID filter.

Mono PWM

Pulse with a slow triangle LFO on the pulse width, some sub and legato glide.

Ladder Fat

Saw plus a second saw detuned 8 cents and some sub, through the warm LADDER filter.

Ladder Pluck

Detuned saws through the LADDER filter with a strong envelope and the amp sustain at 0, for a pluck.

Ladder Glide

Saws with the second oscillator an octave up, a brighter LADDER filter, 90 ms legato glide and a touch of vibrato.

Wide Reese

Saws detuned 22 cents with UNISON at 60% through the clean 12 dB filter, a slow LFO moving the cutoff.

Wide Growl

Detuned saws with unison and a little noise, a resonant LADDER filter swept by a triangle LFO.

Sine Sub

Pulse with a heavy sub through the 12 dB filter at 250 Hz, no resonance: an almost pure sub bass.

Synth Pop	A narrow 30% pulse with sub and a detuned second oscillator through a bright ACID filter.
Zap Bass	Saw through the ACID filter at 200 Hz with the envelope fully up and a 90 ms decay - a zap on every note.
Wobble	Detuned saws with unison through a resonant LADDER filter, a 3 Hz sine LFO sweeping the cutoff.

Tips

- For acid lines, set GLIDE to LEG and play overlapping notes where you want slides; vary the velocity for accents.
- If the bass disappears on small speakers, switch SUB+ on and raise UPPER a little.
- Raise KEY when playing higher lines, so the filter doesn't sound duller the higher you go.
- Lower VOLUME rather than relying on CLIP if the CLIP key flashes on every note.

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